Joshua Tesch

joshuastesch@gmail.com · joshuatesch.dev

SUMMARY

Full-stack web developer with 4+ years building production WordPress, headless CMS, and JavaScript applications, now owning a marketing website end to end: architecture, performance, SEO, analytics, accessibility, and content strategy. Builds AI tooling that does real work: a 25-tool MCP server for WordPress management and a fully autonomous multi-LLM SEO audit pipeline (OpenAI, Gemini, Claude). Cut CSS 84%, fixed GA4 data inflated ~2x, and completed a full WordPress/WP Engine migration with 26 verified redirects. Comfortable at every layer, from block.json to Python orchestration to the WordPress REST API.

SKILLS

Languages: JavaScript (ES6+) · TypeScript · Python · PHP · HTML5 · CSS / SCSS

Frameworks & Libraries: React · Next.js · Node.js · Tailwind CSS · Bootstrap

CMS & E-Commerce: WordPress (themes, plugins, CPTs, Gutenberg blocks, ACF) · Headless WordPress · Shopify (Liquid) · WooCommerce · Strapi · Elementor

AI & Automation: Claude API · OpenAI API (GPT-4o, web_search_preview) · Google Gemini API · Model Context Protocol (MCP server authoring) · Multi-LLM orchestration

APIs & Integrations: Google Search Console API (OAuth) · GA4 API · Google Sheets API · DataForSEO API · Firecrawl API · WordPress REST API

Performance & SEO: Core Web Vitals (LCP, TBT, CLS, FCP) · WCAG accessibility · Yoast SEO · Structured data (JSON-LD) · Programmatic SEO at scale

Tools: Git · Docker · AWS (EC2, S3) · Vercel · Figma · WP-CLI · Adobe XD

EXPERIENCE

Web Developer — Website Engineering, AI Tooling & Marketing Strategy

Reading Horizons · Jan 2026 – Present

Technical owner of the marketing website; scope expanded from development into SEO, analytics, and content strategy. 253 documented changes/initiatives from Feb to Sep 2026 (26 rated high impact).

AI tooling & automation

- Built **wp-expert**, a 25-tool Node.js MCP server exposing WordPress management to AI assistants (Claude, Cursor, VS Code): dual-site routing, write confirmation gate, dynamic REST path resolution, ACF fallback, self-refreshing schema, 6 modules (Read, Write, Advise, Yoast, Media, ACF)
- Architected **weekly_audit.py**, an autonomous Python pipeline replacing a manual analyst workflow: orchestrates Search Console, DataForSEO, Firecrawl, and three LLM APIs; computes week-over-week deltas for 70+ metrics; publishes a tabbed HTML dashboard to WordPress via REST
- Built **ai_visibility_check.py** (30 queries/run across GPT-4o-mini, Gemini Flash, Claude Haiku; Share of Voice vs. 7 competitors) and **site_audit_analyzer.py** (up to 700-page crawls, 15 SEO checks, weighted 0-100 health score, AI-crawler robots.txt rules) • Used scripted automation for high-volume metadata, taxonomy classification, and schema work: 124 meta descriptions, 196 title overrides, and 1,308 image alt texts pushed programmatically

Performance, analytics & SEO

- Reduced Tailwind CSS **84%** (696 KB to 112 KB); lazy-loaded a 12 MB Lottie asset; improved LCP loading; deferred the LinkedIn Insight Tag (mobile Lighthouse Best Practices 81 to 100)
- Diagnosed and removed a duplicate GA4 destination that had inflated pageview/event data ~2x; extended event retention from 2 to 14 months; added scroll-depth and CTA/conversion events in GTM so reporting could be trusted
- Rebuilt the blog taxonomy around 9 approved content pillars with 301 redirects and governance (role-gated term creation, searchable Topic picker); Topic tags rolled out across 160 posts
- Added structured data (NewsArticle, PodcastEpisode, VideoObject, FAQPage); noindexed 45 utility pages

Platform & migration

- Completed the RISE site migration from Squarespace to WordPress/WP Engine: 26 verified redirects, DNS cutover, SSL, SPF/email continuity, SEO and schema cleanup, alt text on 70/70 images; hosting consolidation saves ~$331/yr

- Built 5 custom blocks/CPTs (Download Cards, Literacy Talks podcast CPT, Gravity Forms block, Report Microsite CPT, Featured News archive) plus reusable Gutenberg/ACF patterns for non-technical editors

- Centralized AJAX/pagination (~954 lines each) into shared handlers; secured internal reports (login gating, XML-RPC disabled, nonce checks, rate-limited security logging)
- Maintain a Web Change Tracker as the cross-team record of changes, rationale, and rollback references

Web Developer

STRS Development · 2025 – 2026

- Collaborated on scalable, production-ready web applications with emphasis on usability and performance
- Implemented features and UI updates across the full stack

Web Developer

Omni Creative · Contractor · 2024 – 2026

- Built custom WordPress and Shopify storefronts with modular block templates and reusable components
- Contributed performance and layout recommendations during planning and review

Web Developer

9th South Digital · Contractor · 2022 – 2026

- Built applications across WordPress, headless CMS, and eCommerce platforms (WooCommerce, Shopify)
- Developed custom themes and reusable components; provided UX and performance recommendations

FEATURED PROJECTS

wp-expert MCP Server — 25-tool Node.js MCP server for AI-driven WordPress management. Dual-site support, write confirmation gate, dynamic REST resolution, ACF fallback, self-refreshing schema system. *(Node.js, @modelcontextprotocol/sdk, WordPress REST API)*

Autonomous SEO Audit Pipeline — End-to-end weekly audit replacing manual analyst work: rankings (GSC), keywords (DataForSEO), multi-LLM brand visibility, Firecrawl site health scoring, WordPress dashboard publish. One CLI command, zero manual steps. *(Python 3.14, OpenAI API, Gemini API, Claude API, DataForSEO, Firecrawl, GA4)*

The Piped Peony — Full-stack e-commerce application with headless CMS. *(Next.js, TypeScript, Strapi, Tailwind CSS)*

Celebree School — Enterprise WordPress theme for a multi-location brand with complex content architecture.

Forevering Jewelry — Custom Shopify storefront. *(Liquid)*

EDUCATION

Associate of Science in Computer Science — Salt Lake Community College, Taylorsville, UT

Emphasis in Network Infrastructure, Linux Administration, and Cybersecurity